

THE THIRD FROG IN A BLENDER

2025

"What are you talking about? That's preposterous! I'm not in a blender. Only bad frogs are put in blenders. I'm a good frog. Besides, if I were in a blender, I would be getting cut from the blades constantly. As it is, I've only been cut one time, and that was when I was a tadpole. So that proves I'm not in a blender!

"Not to mention, there are a couple of sexy young frogs that recently appeared, and I think one of them likes me. I'm going to wear my bathing suit so that she can clearly see that I never get cut. I've heard that girls really like frogs who never get cut."

"Heya, sexay. Whatchu doin' in a place like this?" Mr. Frog blurts out in an unapologetically sleazy manner.

A blade cuts her.

"Ouch! I could really use a place to stay. I don't see any cuts on you.

How do you do it? You must know of somewhere I can stay where I'll be *safe*!" She exclaims while batting her eyelashes.

"Oh, I can think of a place."

Predictably, Mr. Frog leads her straight to his bed.

"Here ya go, sugar plum. All snug as a bug in a rug. But don't you want to take those dirty old clothes off?"

While Mr Frog is enjoying a sleepless night with his new friend, a blade cuts him.

"Are you all right?"

"No, I'm not all right. What is this? You dirty slut! You didn't tell me that you had *mold*!"

"You didn't ask either!"

In a fit of rage, Mr. Frog pushes her down into the ground, which is actually the well-blended bodies of the frogs that came before him. He pushes until she, too, becomes part of the ground.

Mr. Frog is now racked with guilt and fearful that other frogs may find out and seek revenge for what he's done. Even frogs who never knew the girl would jump in on the action just out of the principle of the thing. Although, Mr. Frog had his doubts about that being their true motivation.

Another blade cuts him.

Mr. Frog has now been cut too many times to be able to hide his

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injuries, so he simply stops trying. He no longer cares if anyone sees that he's been cut.

A close friend pulls Mr. Frog aside and counsels him that the other frogs don't like to be reminded of the blades. So it would be in Mr. Frog's best interest to continue to hide them as best he can.

He goes on to say, "The blender is what you make of it. You just have to have the right attitude and things can turn out great for you in here! All of those cuts happened for a reason. You're supposed to learn from them. That's the only way to avoid being cut again. You need to search deep within yourself to find the meaning and purpose behind your having been put here. Once you're aligned with your purpose, you'll have no limits and surely your conditions in here will improve!"

Mr. Frog begins to meditate and reflect. He invents meaning and purpose and feels exceptionally aligned as *a blade cuts him deep*. It seems the blades are unconcerned with the state of Mr. Frog's enlightenment. Then *another cuts him*. It seems as though the frequency has actually increased rather than decreased!

Mr. Frog returns to town. He can hear people snicker as he walks past them in his ripped clothes covered in blood stains. Then, delighted, he sees an old friend and rushes up to say "hi!" and catch up.

"What happened to you?" the friend asks with an unapologetic sneer.

"Oh, this? Yes. I seem to have lost a fight with some blades", Mr. Frog replied apologetically.

"I see. Well, I'm running late. I must get my parrot to the barber."

"Could I perhaps trouble you for a couple bandages. I promise I can

pay you back! It's just that I can't work in this condition. But with bandages, I could heal, do meaningful work, and then I could repay you.", Mr. Frog pleaded.

"Alright, let's drop the bullshit. We both know if I give you bandages, you're just going to get cut up even worse than you are now. It's what *people like you* do. There's nothing I can do to help you. *You're a lost cause.* I suggest that you reflect on all of the decisions *you've made* that have led you to this point. You're the captain of your ship. *You've got no one to blame but yourself!*" The friend's voice trails off as he walks away.

"He doesn't even own a parrot!" Mr. Frog realizes far too late.

Convinced that bandages really would help, Mr. Frog visits a pharmacy where the pharmacist, Mr. Turtle, reluctantly hands Mr. Frog a single bandage that is much too small to be of any real help to close any of his wounds.

"Well, that's what we have allocated for *you people*. You should have thought about this before *you decided* to dance among the blades without any protection!" says Mr. Turtle sternly as he taps his *shell* with his cane.

"But I wasn't born with a shell." Mr. Frog replies.

"That's not my fault. But I'm sure if you applied yourself, *you could construct one.* You can't just *sit around* and wait for other people to *give you everything* in life, you know? Just *pull yourself up* by your bootstr..."

A blade cuts through the room.

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Mr. Turtle deflects it, taking a small chip from his shell. Cosmetic damage. He brushes himself off...and then notices Mr. Frog's lifeless body in the corner.

"Well, that's what happens when *you're irresponsible*.", Mr. Turtle says with a snicker.